Day 8 (stop 3 of 3) - Lower Falls, Louth, Staff Avenue, Midway

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Niagara section · hike 12 · Louth Conservation Area

3.4 km / 2.1 mi	~1.0 h	2.7 km new	77 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Louth Conservation Area: Enter from Staff Ave, 500 m north of Pelham Rd (Regional Rd 69). Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day08c_hike012.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Lower Falls Side Trail (1.6 km); Louth Side Trail (0.6 km); Staff Avenue Side Trail (0.3 km); Midway Side Trail (0.2 km)

Same day: this is stop 3 of 3 on day 8 (8.0 mi of hiking, about 162 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 1: hike 10, 4.3 mi from Grimsby Lions Community Pool; stop 2: hike 11, 1.6 mi from Mountainview Conservation Area.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Louth Conservation Area is entered from Staff Ave, 500 m north of Pelham Rd (Regional Rd 69). Signage is sparse. There are no washrooms. The area is open year-round from sunrise to sunset; NPCA gives no fee details (905-788-3135).
- **Staff Avenue Side Trail:** A well-defined path from the lot into the woods that meets the main trail. Horses use this trail, so watch for them.
- **Main Bruce Trail & Louth Falls:** Escarpment forest above the Sixteen Mile Creek valley, with old rock formations and songbirds. Louth Falls is near the Louth Side Trail junction. The gorge has no easy way down, so enjoy the view from above.
- **Louth & Midway Side Trails:** Short side trails off the main trail; the Louth Side Trail does not lead to the falls. No terrain details were found.
- **Dogs & hemlocks:** NPCA asks you to stay on trails and keep dogs leashed. This helps limit the spread of hemlock woolly adelgid, an invasive pest found nearby. Clean boots and gear, and don't take branches or twigs.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Louth Conservation Area: Enter from Staff Ave, 500 m north of Pelham Rd (Regional Rd 69). Head north on the blue-blazed Staff Avenue Side Trail.
0.3	0.2	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.) Then, turn right onto the blue-blazed Louth Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
0.9	0.6	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
1.2	0.7	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Lower Falls Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)

2.8	1.7	J4: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Midway Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
3.0	1.9	J5: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
3.1	1.9	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the Louth Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.) Then, continue straight onto the blue-blazed Staff Avenue Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
3.4	2.1	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on NPCA and Go Waterfalling.